Sales Performance Analysis Report

Introduction

This report presents an analysis of sales performance based on the Superstore dataset, with the objective of understanding what drives revenue and profitability within the business. The analysis aims not only to describe performance, but also to identify inefficiencies and highlight potential areas for improvement. All steps were carried out in Microsoft Excel, including data preparation, exploratory analysis, and the creation of an interactive dashboard.

Data Preparation

Before starting the analysis, the dataset was carefully prepared to ensure consistency and reliability. Duplicate records were removed and the dataset was checked for missing values, which were not present. Date formats were standardized to allow for time-based analysis, and non-relevant columns were excluded in order to keep the dataset focused and efficient. Additionally, two new variables were created to support the analysis: Year and Month-Year, extracted from the order date, and the Profit Margin, calculated as the ratio between profit and sales. This preparation phase ensured that the analysis was based on clean and structured data.

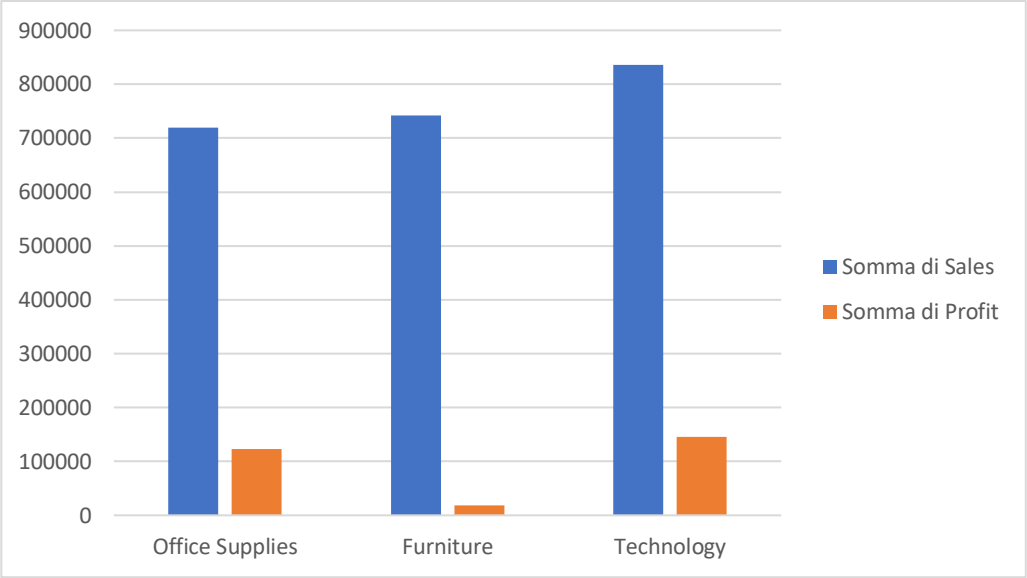
KPI Overview

At an aggregate level, the company generated approximately €2.3 million in total sales, with a total profit of €286,000, resulting in a profit margin of around 12.5%. While the business is overall profitable, the margin suggests that there may be opportunities to improve efficiency and optimize performance.

KPI			
SALES	PROFIT	MARGIN	ORDERS
2.296.919,49 €	286.409,08 €	12,47%	9993

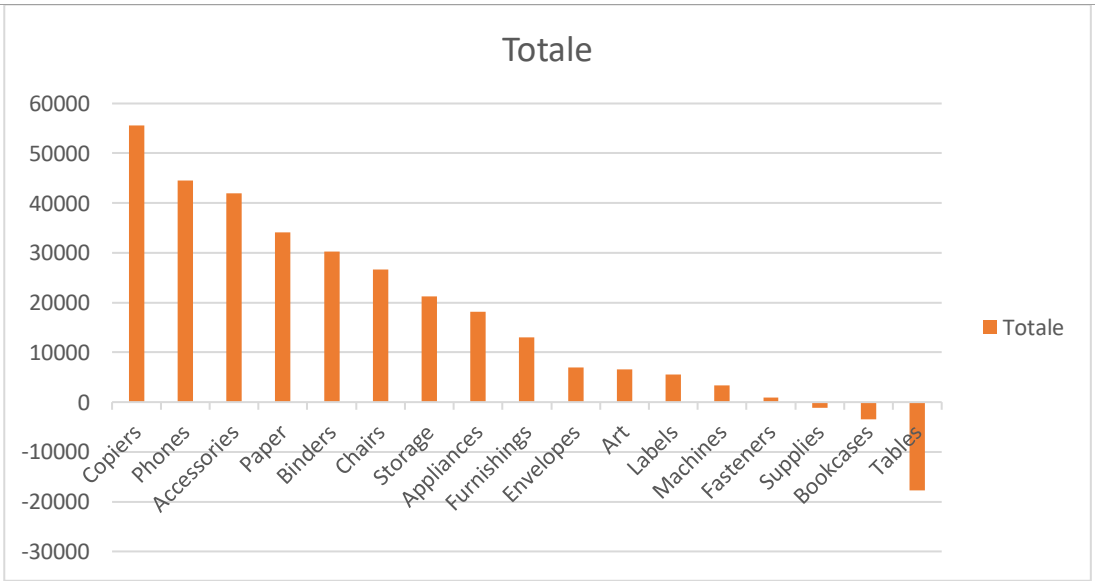
Category Performance

When looking at performance across product categories, clear differences emerge. Technology stands out as the strongest category, driving both revenue and profit. It represents the core of the business and appears to be highly efficient. Office Supplies shows a more balanced and stable performance, contributing consistently to profitability. On the other hand, Furniture generates a significant volume of sales but contributes relatively little to profit. This gap suggests that margins in this category are lower, potentially due to higher costs or aggressive pricing strategies.



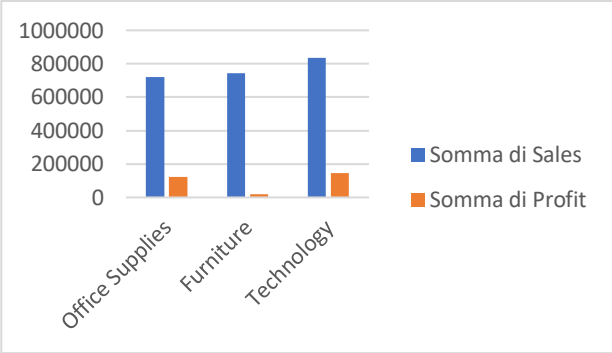
Sub-Category Analysis

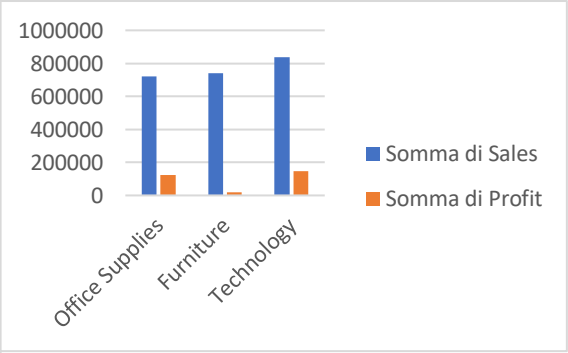
A more detailed view at the sub-category level reveals even more critical insights. Some products, such as Copiers and Phones, are highly profitable and play a key role in driving overall performance. However, not all sub-categories contribute positively. In particular, Tables generate negative profit, meaning they are being sold at a loss. This represents a clear inefficiency and highlights the importance of going beyond high-level analysis to identify issues hidden within specific product groups.



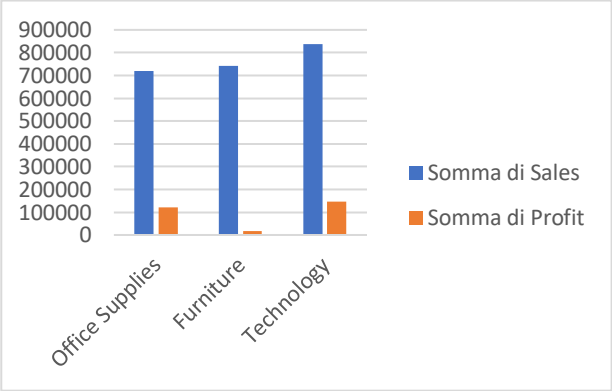
Regional Performance

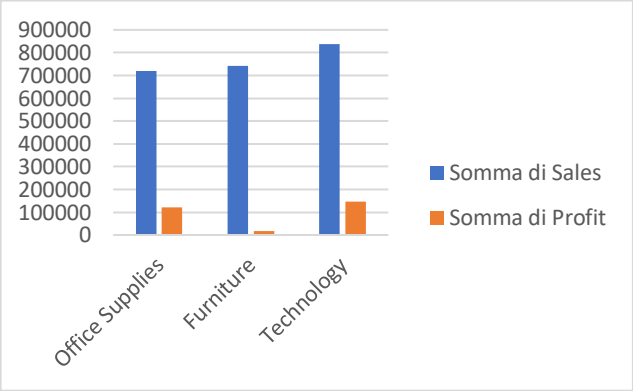
The analysis also shows significant differences across geographic regions. The West and East regions perform strongly, both in terms of sales and profitability, and appear to be the most successful markets for the business.





In contrast, the South and Central regions show weaker performance. This could be due to lower demand, higher costs, or less effective market strategies.

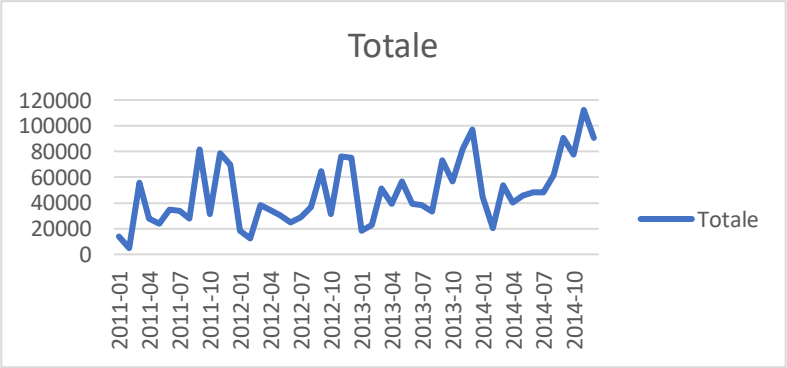


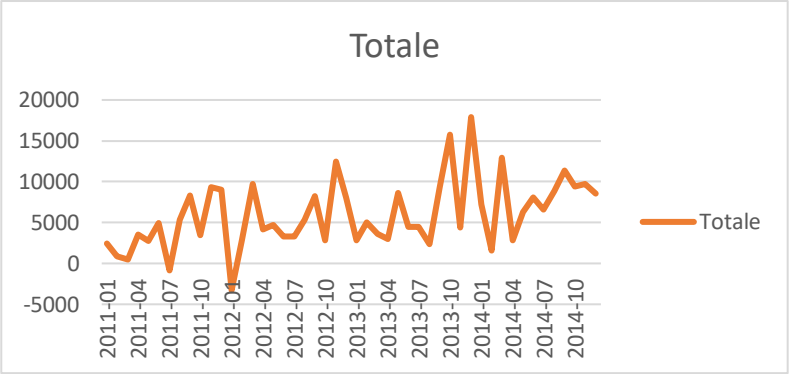


These differences suggest that performance is not uniform and that regional strategies may need to be adjusted.

Sales Trend Over Time

Looking at sales over time, the overall trend is positive, indicating that the business is growing. However, the trend is not perfectly smooth, as there are noticeable fluctuations and peaks. These patterns may reflect seasonal demand or specific periods of increased activity. Understanding these dynamics could help improve planning and forecasting.





Business Recommendations

Based on the analysis, several actions can be considered to improve performance. First, it would be important to review the pricing and cost structure of low-margin categories, particularly Furniture, in order to improve profitability. Second, loss-making products such as Tables should be carefully evaluated. This could involve optimizing costs, adjusting prices, or in some cases discontinuing the product altogether. At the same time, the company should continue to invest in high-performing categories like Technology, which clearly drive value. Finally, targeted strategies should be developed to improve performance in underperforming regions, especially the South and Central areas.

Tools Used

The entire analysis was conducted using Microsoft Excel, including data cleaning, pivot tables, dashboard creation, and interactive slicers.